Whitman E.S.

Changes beginning in 2028-29

WHAT'S HAPPENING?

- Whitman would remain open as a neighborhood K-5 school and expand its school boundary to receive 100% of the students from the closing Woodmere K-5 school.
- Whitman neighborhood students would continue to Brentwood M.S. and then move on to Franklin H.S. instead of Cleveland H.S.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

- Low neighborhood enrollment: Both Whitman and Woodmere are significantly under district enrollment goals, with Woodmere's enrollment remaining in the low 220s.
- Central school space: Whitman has room for 416 students, and receiving students from Woodmere makes better use of school space in a centrally located school with planned schoolyard improvements.

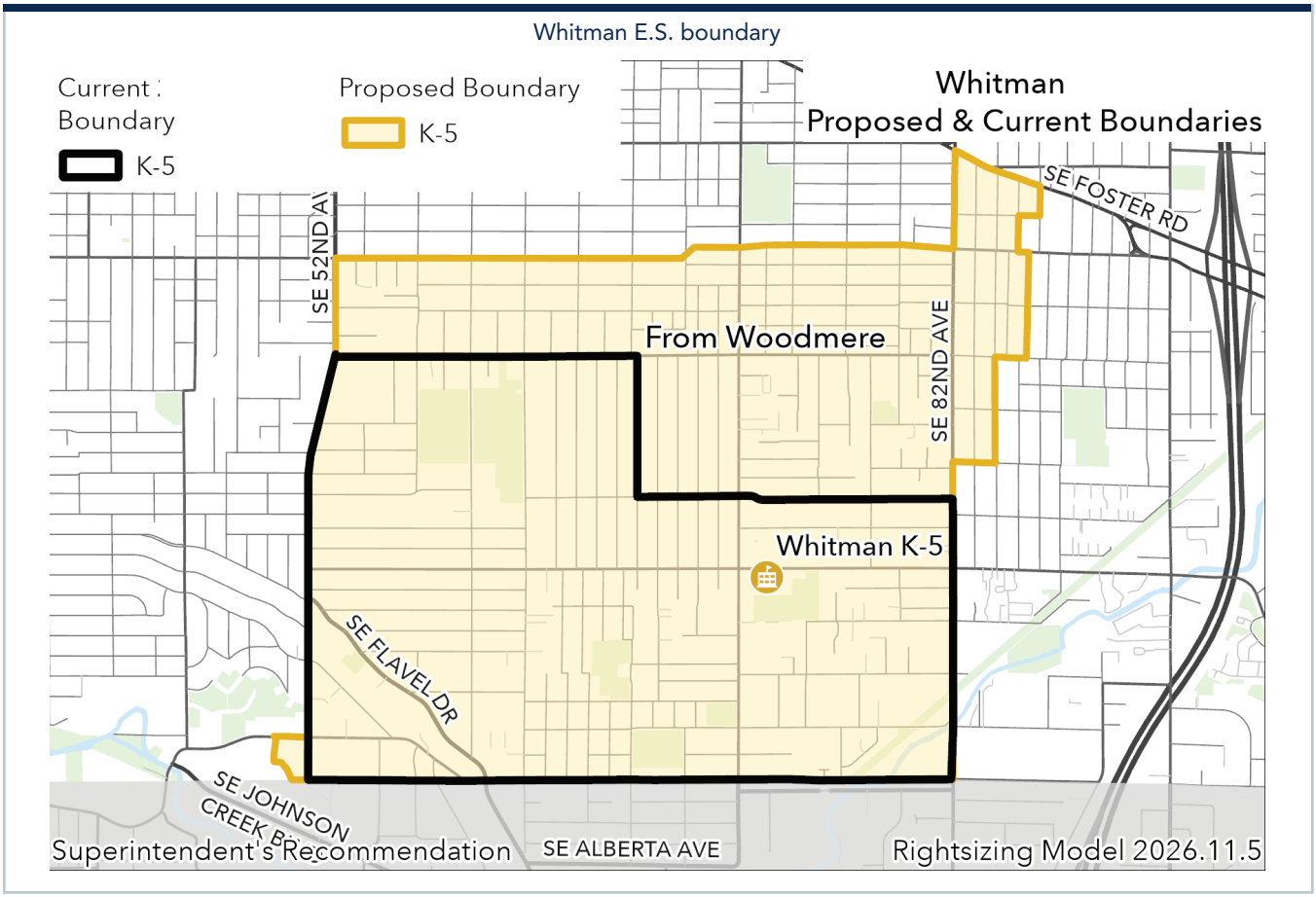
WHAT ELSE WAS CONSIDERED?

- Whitman chosen over Woodmere: Whitman was chosen over Woodmere because of being more central to where students live and having a similar amount of space and building conditions.

WHAT WOULD STUDENTS GAIN?

- Upgraded school grounds: Benefit from planned schoolyard improvements and a central location.
- Combined school strength: Combining both schools helps keep student numbers steady, allowing for additional learning options, increased staffing and upgraded learning environments.

WHERE WOULD THE SCHOOL BOUNDARY BE?



SCHOOL BUILDING CAPACITY & ENROLLMENT

	Functional Capacity	Utilization %	Historical Peak Enrollment	Current Enrollment (2026-2027)
Receiving site	416	49.3%	475 (2001-02)	215

Projected enrollment

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Status Quo/No Change	205	216	217	222	223
Recommendation	206	444	446	446	456

ENROLLMENT AND TRANSFER

- Neighborhood students: K-4th grade students and incoming K students residing in the Woodmere attendance area will enroll at Whitman E.S. Additionally, 8th grade students residing in the Whitman attendance area will enroll at Franklin for 9th grade.

- PPS transfer students: K-4th grade students attending Woodmere but not residing in the attendance area will enroll at Whitman E.S. or may transfer to their neighborhood school by home address.

WHO WOULD THE SCHOOL SERVE?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
Status Quo/No Change	64.4%	28.4%	18%	40.2%	Title 1
Recommendation	56.9%	27.6%	20.2%	35.3%	Title 1

ACADEMIC PROGRAM TRANSITIONS

- Special Education: Currently, Whitman is an Inclusive School Community with three Learning Center Classes. With rightsizing, Whitman will receive students from Woodmere and continue to be an Inclusive School Community with five Learning Center classes.
- Student and Family Supports: Morrison Child and Family Services is identified as Whitman's school-based mental health partner for 2026–27. Student Services will review how existing partnership services can support students as district school-change plans are finalized.

SCHOOL BUILDING INFORMATION

Facility Indicator	Classroom Capacity	Special Education: Dedicated spaces & accessibility	Cafeteria / Nutrition Services	Gymnasium
Readiness	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

TRANSPORTATION

Transportation	2028-2029
Students living within walkable zone – Elementary (1 mile), Middle (1.5 miles)	75.2%
Eligible bus riders	85
Estimated number of routes (not including special ed routes)	2
Hazard transportation routes (included in total routes above)	0

REINVESTMENTS FOR RECEIVING SCHOOLS

Schools that receive additional students through consolidation will be allocated a proportion of the total programmatic savings that result from Rightsizing actions. This allocation will be distributed as discretionary FTE that can be used for instructional coaching, academic intervention, school climate support, social work, or duty support. School principals, with consultation from their school communities and approval from their Senior Directors of Instructional Leadership, will determine how to use these additional investments.

School transition supports: Teams from Central Office have developed a framework for implementing Rightsizing. This includes a menu of transition supports for all impacted school communities. This work is informed by lessons learned by districts across the country that have had successful school consolidations. The implementation framework includes guidance on merging academic programs and school-based teams, (such as Instructional Leadership, Climate, PTAs and others) tools, resources, and timelines. The framework includes timelines for merging school communities and onboarding staff, families and students to their new campuses. It also includes staffing timelines and plans for packing and moving furniture and instructional resources. This comprehensive framework will be shared with the community in December. If the Board of Education votes to proceed with Rightsizing for fall 2027, Central Office teams will begin working with school communities in January to implement transition supports appropriate to each community.